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Design Thinking

21 May 2025

Freedom of Expression at Dartmouth

Guidelines for the User Interview:

- Set up interviews with people who are central to your topic. Use your notebooks and video to capture details (make sure to get consent before recording!). Ask for stories. Follow up with “why” questions to move between emotional experiences/needs and tangible things/actions. After your first few interviews, evaluate your questions and responses. Refine questions to get deeper insights.
- Carefully select whom you should interview to get the info you need, and reach out early. (It can take some time to get on people’s calendars). Don’t just interview your friends. Get out there and talk to people who really understand and care about your topic. These people can include faculty, staff, and administrators.

Interview Questions:

- How has your experience of expressing your opinions been at Dartmouth? Could you bring a particular example?
- What’s your opinion on the Dartmouth Dialogue Project?
- What’s your opinion on student protests at American universities?
- Is Dartmouth practicing “brave space”?
- What would you wish to see for enhancing Dartmouth students expressing their freedom of speech and expression?

Interview Notes, 20/5 and 21/5:

Person 1 - Student:

Person 1 - an international freshman student

AGE RANGE

18-20

FRUSTRATIONS

- I can influence little on decision-making because I'm freshman and an international student.
- Dartmouth needs to protect its students, including international students from ICE, the Trump administration threats

WANTS/NEEDS

- I wish Dartmouth implemented an initiative that bridges the gap between freshman and upperclassmen.
- Just like SDG 2030 goals, Dartmouth should implement 10-year plan.

QUOTES

- I think Dartmouth should have activities more relating to free speech.
- I wish there could be a platform that helps us tell our opinions anonymously, especially given visa cancellations on international students.

DARTMOUTH INVOLVEMENT

ACTIVE IN
EXTRACURRICULARS

INACTIVE IN
EXTRACURRICULARS

SATISFIED WITH FREE
SPEECH ON CAMPUS

DISSATISFIED WITH
FREE SPEECH ON
CAMPUS



Person 2 - Faculty:

Person 2 - a professor in History department

AGE RANGE

50-60

FRUSTRATIONS

- Faculty sometimes has little voice during the Dartmouth administration decision-making.
- Dartmouth education isn't merely a piece of paper but learning about one's rights and power as a person, and using that power to influence a positive change.

WANTS/NEEDS

- A dedicated event like Powwow that helps spread information about the Dartmouth history, history of its students, and educating Hanover community.

QUOTES

- Dartmouth students historically have been involved with free speech like anti-genocide encampment in South Africa.
- Class environment and external world are inseparable.

DARTMOUTH INVOLVEMENT

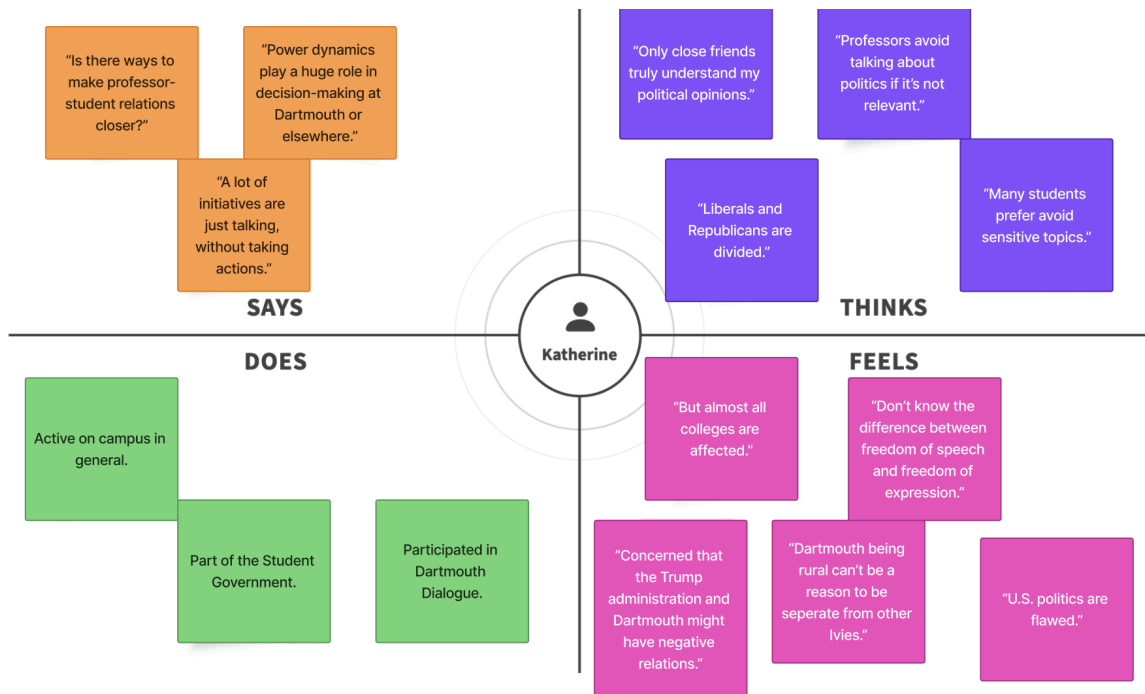
ACTIVE IN FACULTY
DECISION-MAKING

INACTIVE IN FACULTY
DECISION-MAKING

SATISFIED WITH FREE
SPEECH ON CAMPUS

DISSATISFIED WITH
FREE SPEECH ON
CAMPUS

Person 3 - Student:



Person 4 - Student:

Audio interview

Person 5 - Student:
Audio interview

Person 6 - Student:
Audio interview